"My body determines my worth."

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Where it often comes from

Fitness culture, medical anxiety, fashion, and sexual objectification tell us that our value is how our bodies look or perform. Illness, injury, aging, and weight changes can then feel like losses of worth, not merely of function.

What Scripture teaches

God created humanity "in His own image," which is true of every person and every body. Paul writes, "Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you…? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God with your body." The psalmist says, "All my days were written in Your book." Paul adds, "Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." Our bodies are gifts to steward, not measures of our worth.

> *"Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God with your body"* (1 Corinthians 6:19–20).

Also see

> "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them" (Genesis 1:27).

> "My frame was not hidden from You when I was made in secret, when I was woven together in the depths of the earth. Your eyes saw my unformed body; all my days were written in Your book and ordained for me before one of them came to be" (Psalm 139:15–16).

> "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day" (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered" (Matthew 10:30).

Common self-statements

- I am only as valuable as my body looks or performs.
- If my body fails, I fail.
- My body is the problem.
- Aging means losing value.
- I am worth more when I am thin or fit.
- I hate my body.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Equating myself with my body's condition.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing my body as perfect or worthless.
- Perfectionism: Demanding an ideal I cannot sustain.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dissatisfied and concluding that my worth is low.

Challenging questions

- How have I linked my worth to my body, and where did I learn it?
- What can my body do that I overlook?
- What does it mean that I am made in God's image?
- What does it mean to steward a body, not worship or punish it?
- How would I treat a friend's body or illness?
- What is one kind thing I can do for my body?

Truth summary

> My worth comes from being made in God's image and bought at a price, not from how my body looks or performs. I can steward my body with care and thanks, whatever its condition.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Gifts, Physical/Material
- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Sickness
- Thinking, Unhealthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My body determines my worth"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My body determines my worth." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I link worth to my body?
- ☐ What can my body do?
- ☐ What does image of God mean?
- ☐ What does stewardship look like?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What kind thing can I do?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ My body is a temple of the Spirit.
- ☐ I was bought at a price.
- ☐ My days are written in God's book.
- ☐ My inner self is being renewed.
- ☐ I can care for my body with kindness.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **1 Corinthians 6:19–20**
  "Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God with your body."
- ☐ **Genesis 1:27**
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."
- ☐ **2 Corinthians 4:16**
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Worth beyond the body: Each day, name one thing your body did for you and one thing that is true of you apart from your body.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, 1 Corinthians 6:19–20 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I was bought at a price, so my worth is not my body.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Gifts, Physical/Material" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Notice the equation. Write when you link your worth to your body.
- ☐ Thank your body. List ten things your body lets you do.
- ☐ Care, do not punish. Choose a gentle habit such as rest or a walk.
- ☐ Memorize 2 Corinthians 4:16. Say it on hard body days.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My body determines my worth": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Worth beyond the body
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My body determines my worth.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You made me in Your image and bought me at a price. Free me from measuring my worth by my body. Help me care for it with gratitude. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.